

Blake Nipper

SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 5+ years at Amazon spanning incident response, digital forensics, and application security penetration testing. Hands-on offensive security experience across web applications and AWS cloud infrastructure; including the discovery of a critical PHI exposure impacting thousands of records. Deep AWS expertise backed by professional-level certifications and SANS GIAC credentials in forensics and Python. Currently pursuing a Master's in Cybersecurity at Georgia Tech.

EXPERIENCE

Amazon	March 2025 - April 2026
Security Engineer II, Application Security	(Remote)

- Identified a critical-severity Protected Health Information (PHI) exposure across thousands of instances in internal service ticketing infrastructure, driving HIPAA-compliance remediation at scale
- Conducted web application and API penetration testing with a focus on OWASP Top 10 attack classes across internal Amazon services
- Performed cloud security assessments targeting AWS IAM privilege escalation paths, EC2 configurations, and network segmentation gaps
- Authored formal penetration test reports translating technical risk findings into actionable remediation guidance for engineering teams and leadership

Amazon	July 2024 - March 2025
Security Engineer II, Incident Response	(Remote)

- Developed Python automation for an internal case management system, significantly reducing triage and assessment time across bulk security cases
- Conducted forensic acquisitions and analysis on dozens of Linux hosts, improving incident resolution effectiveness across complex investigations
- Standardized executive security event communication guidelines, adopted across a global team of 40+ engineers
- Mentored new hires and overhauled onboarding documentation, reducing ramp-up time for incoming security engineers
- Conducted technical and cultural interviews, influencing hiring decisions to grow a high-performing security operations team

Amazon	November 2022 - July 2024
Security Engineer I	(Remote)

- Led incident response investigations using host-based forensic analysis and multi-source log correlation to determine root cause across high-severity events
- Enhanced risk management system integrations, enabling leadership to surface and prioritize systemic security issues faster
- Improved detection and response strategy through deep Splunk analysis of CloudTrail, Linux, Windows, VPC flow, and CrowdStrike log sources

- Developed and maintained incident response playbooks, standardizing security operations practices and improving response consistency

Amazon

July 2022 - November 2022

Security Support Engineer

(Remote)

- Led on-call security response teams assessing and mitigating threats across Amazon's enterprise environment
- Investigated security alerts across Linux and Windows systems, improving internal cybersecurity hygiene

Amazon Web Services

October 2021 – July 2022

Cloud Support Engineer

(Remote)

- Resolved 240+ complex AWS security cases with consistent 5-star customer ratings
- Earned 6 AWS certifications demonstrating cross-domain cloud platform depth

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology · M.S. Cybersecurity (OMSCS) · Fall 2025 – May 2027

Brigham Young University · B.A. Chinese Studies · 2016 – 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional**
- **AWS Certified Security – Specialty**
- **GCFE — SANS FOR500 (Windows Forensic Examination)**
- **GPYC — SANS SEC573 (Automating Information Security with Python)**
- **CBBH — HTB Academy (Certified Bug Bounty Hunter)**

SKILLS

- **Cloud & Security:** Incident Response, Digital Forensics, Penetration Testing, Application Security, AWS (IAM, EC2, VPC, S3, CloudTrail, GuardDuty, Security Hub)
- **Offensive Security:** OWASP Top 10, Web Application & API Testing, Cloud Infrastructure Assessment, Network Penetration Testing
- **Automation & Tooling:** Python scripting, security workflow automation, internal tool development
- **Log Analysis:** Splunk (CloudTrail, Linux, Windows, VPC flow logs, CrowdStrike)
- **Languages:** Fluent in Mandarin Chinese

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- **(ISC)² Member**
- **ISACA Member**
- **OWASP Member**
- **Hack The Box**